





Clockwise from left: Public art punctuates streets; Murals; A chef puts on finishing touches; Brisbane's food scene blends Asian and Pacific influences with Queensland produce, from seafood to native citrus
Image 8 - Fertile volcanic soil in the Scenic Rim supports small farms and producers supplying Brisbane's kitchens.

Brisbane, Australia

With the 2032 Olympics approaching, Brisbane is undergoing a visible transformation. It is most evident along the river, where former industrial edges have softened into spaces for walking and relaxing, especially at Howard Smith Wharves and along the still-developing sections of Queen's Wharf and South Bank.

This is also where the city's food culture comes into focus, relaxed and confident, built around ingredients like barramundi, Moreton Bay bugs, finger lime, and lemon myrtle, and influenced by Indigenous, Asian, and Pacific traditions. The city's cultural pull centres on QAGOMA, the Queensland Art Gallery and Gallery of Modern Art, now among the region's most significant institutions. Its flagship Asia Pacific Triennial attracts artists and ideas from across Asia and the Pacific, transforming Brisbane into a true crossroads of contemporary art.

But the change is most noticeable on foot. In Fish Lane, once a service alley and now a seam between South Bank and West End, murals turn walls into landmarks, and a narrow strip of small restaurants and wine bars keeps the street lively late into the night. Then, quite swiftly, the city thins into landscape. In the Scenic Rim, an hour south of Brisbane, days revolve around volcanic soil, small producers, and a thoughtful food culture. It is this easy transition between city and country, along with a strong appetite for change, that gives Brisbane its very current appeal.



